wholesale prices exceeding both last year's levels and the five-year average across most markets.

Humanitarian food assistance

Humanitarian food assistance in El Salvador remains limited in scale and geographic coverage. WFP is planning targeted assistance in the Dry Corridor, providing cash-based transfers to households in advance of anticipated poor rainfall, reaching approximately 4,288 people. However, assistance remains localized and insufficient in scale to reach enough people to significantly affect acute food insecurity classification.

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Updates to key assumptions about atypical food security conditions through April 2026

Most of the assumptions that underpinned FEWS NET's analysis of the most likely scenario for the El Salvador Food Security Outlook February to September 2026 remain valid; however, the following updates have been made to incorporate new evidence:

- **Below-average labor demand and incomes for *primera* staple-crop production** is likely due to erratic and below-average rainfall, above-average temperatures, anticipated localized disruptions to *primera* planting and negative impacts to crop development throughout the season.

- **Fertilizer prices are expected to rise in the medium term, despite adequate availability through commercial suppliers and government-subsidized fertilizer sales and distribution centers.** Price transmission effects and possible speculative behavior are likely to raise input costs, especially for smallholder farmers purchasing later in the *primera* season or at the start of *postrera* planting, constraining agricultural investment and limiting yields.

- **Sustained increases in international oil prices are likely to be partially transmitted to local markets**, exacerbating seasonal price increases for staple foods, particularly in remote areas where transportation costs account for a larger share of food prices.

- ***Postrera* planting is expected to face delays, particularly in rainfed areas.** Erratic and below-average rainfall and inadequate soil moisture conditions during the typical July–August planting window are likely to result